

The Hoover Dashboard

Hoover in your browser: the pre-race checks, start and stop, and the race as it airs. No more typing commands.

What it is. A page that opens in your web browser and runs Hoover for you. It checks the PC before a race, listens to the game to see who is in the lobby, starts the session you pick, and shows the running order, every line as it airs and every camera cut. It runs on your PC only: nothing goes on the internet, and nobody else can see it.

It sits in your Hoover folder next to the tool, and every `git pull` updates both. It never changes the tool: if the page ever misbehaves, Hoover still runs from the console or **Start Hoover.bat** exactly as before.

1 Get it (once)

PowerShell, in your Hoover folder (`D:\Repository001`):

```
git stash
git fetch origin
git checkout claude/v4-state-blob
git pull
python T11_F125_Baby_Hoover_V4_050CT26.py --version
```

The first line it prints should read like this (`c656d82` or a newer commit):

```
Baby Hoover V5 (build 090CT26, script 5.0.0) · claude/v4-state-blob @ c656d82
```

`git stash` keeps your local edits safe, as before. If `git checkout` refuses, send Dustin the message it prints. Do not force it.

2 Make the desktop icon (once)

In File Explorer, open your Hoover folder and double-click **Make dashboard shortcut** (with file extensions hidden, Windows lists it as a *Windows Batch File*). A black window says it made the shortcut; press any key. A **Hoover Dashboard** icon is now on your desktop.

3 Open it

Double-click **Hoover Dashboard**. A black window opens, then your browser shows the dashboard at `http://127.0.0.1:8777`.

Leave the black window open the whole time. It is the dashboard: closing it shuts the dashboard down, and closing it during a race can lose that race's files. The chip at the top of the page reads **Connected to Hoover dashboard** while all is well. If it turns red, the black window was closed: double-click the icon again.

Down the left side are five pages, and a **console** sits along the bottom of every page:

Pre-flight · checks before a race

Session · pick and start

Live · the race as it airs

Runs · past sessions

This Hoover · version, updates

The console shows everything Hoover prints, the same text as the old black window. When a tool asks a question (Pick devices, Audio check), type the answer in the box at the bottom and press Enter.

4 Sound, once per PC (and after any audio change)

On **Pre-flight**, press **Pick devices**: type the number for the cable, then for your speakers, in the box at the bottom. Then press **Audio check** with OBS not recording, and answer `y` if you heard the beep. Four green lines in the console = good.

5 Before every race: Pre-flight

Press **Run checks**. Each line is ● green (good), ● yellow (works, but read the grey line under it) or ● red (fix before the race; the grey line says how).

Line	What it checks
This Hoover · Git	Which build this is, and whether anything in the folder was edited by hand
Data files	The files that sit beside the tool all load
Audio packages · devices	Speech can run; your cable and speakers are picked (step 4)
Speech key · Model key	The ElevenLabs and Anthropic keys are set. The model key is needed for the hybrid writer
League roster	Each driver's race number is unique. Yellow is normal tonight; leave the roster off
UDP port 20777	Nothing else (another Hoover, a recorder) is holding the telemetry port

Then, with the game in the lobby or a session and **you spectating**, press **Listen to the game**. In ten seconds it lists every driver as the game sends them: name, race number, whether *show online names* is on, and whether their telemetry is public.

Red on Names means some drivers come through as **"Player"**. That is the driver's own game setting, not Hoover. Ask them to turn on **Show online names** and set **Your telemetry** to **Public**, then listen again. If they can't, Hoover still runs and calls them "the car running fifth".

6 Run the session

On **Session**, pick a starting point. For tonight's races use **Race: live, HYBRID writer**. If the model key is not set, use **Race: live, speech on**. Check the **Tonight** block: *night label practice, night id* today's date. The **Command** box shows exactly what will run. Start the session once the game is in it and you are spectating, then press **Start session**. The page jumps to **Live**: running order (the camera's car marked), lines as they air, spoken / failed, and the share of camera time on humans.

Stop with the red Stop and finalise button. Never stop by closing the black window or the browser in the middle of a race. Stop writes the script, the manifest and tonight's results; it takes a few seconds. **Force stop** appears only if Stop does nothing after 20 seconds, and it does *not* save the run. One session at a time: stop one before starting the next.

7 After the race

Runs lists each session folder with spoken / failed. **Open** shows the folder: zip it without the `.bin` and send it as usual. **Replay** loads that race's capture on the Session page.

Updates: from standby (no race running), go to **This Hoover** and press **Get latest**. The page picks up the new build and any new options by itself.

! If something is off

You see	Do
The browser never opens	Open <code>http://127.0.0.1:8777</code> yourself while the black window is open
The black window shows an error and closes	Send a photo of it. Hoover still runs from Start Hoover.bat
Chip at the top is red, "Not connected"	The black window was closed. Double-click the icon again
Listen to the game: "Cannot listen"	A session or another app holds port 20777. Stop it, then listen
Live page: banner "did not accept the live taps"	Nothing is wrong with the race; the console shows everything. Tell Dustin
Spoken stays 0, or failed climbs	Stop and finalise, run Audio check, fix the red line, start again

Anything else: a screenshot of the page plus a photo of the black window.